Annotated edition — v0.3.7. The complete v0.01 Alpha source with commentary embedded in the listing — context anchored to the lines it explains, not siloed in a separate appendix.

On January 3, 2009, Satoshi Nakamoto launched Bitcoin with a single executable and these 20,000 lines of C++.

This volume walks that first public release file by file. Explanations appear inline: annotation blocks break the code flow where they belong, so you read the original source and the commentary as one continuous thread — data structures, algorithms, and design choices spelled out without leaving the program in front of you.

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Annotations by Claude Sonnet 4.6 (Revised by Opus 4.6, GPT 5.6 Sol, Grok 4.5, Kimi K3, Opus 5.5)

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